NUNO FONTOURA · FREE RESOURCE

TEMPLATE

The Decision Rulebook

Turn recurring approvals into standing rules your team can use without you.

Fillable PDF · 4 pages · 20 minutes per rule

WHY THIS EXISTS

Codify the judgement you already carry

Your team isn't asking for approval because they're unconfident. They're asking because they've never been given the framework to decide without you.

The fix isn't handing tasks off. It's writing down the judgement you use every time, so the same decision doesn't reach your desk twice.

WHAT A DECISION RULE DOES

1

Names when it applies. The trigger that makes this rule the one to use.

2

States the threshold. The number or condition that decides the outcome.

3

Says who decides. A named owner, so nobody has to check with you.

HOW TO USE THIS

1. **Identify the approval.** Something that crossed your desk more than twice last month, where the outcome would have been the same whether you saw it or not.
2. **Write the rule.** Use one rule block per approval. Be specific: a rule with no numbers in it is a suggestion.
3. **Test it.** Hand the decision to its new owner and watch what they do with it once, before you let go completely.

> **Tip:** type into the grey fields and save the file. Share the finished rulebook where your team already works, not in a folder nobody opens.

THE TEMPLATE

Your decision rules

DECISION RULE #1

RECURRING APPROVAL what keeps landing on your desk?

TRIGGER when does this rule apply?

THRESHOLD OR CRITERIA the number that decides it

WHO DECIDES WITHOUT YOU

REVIEW DATE when it gets checked

WHAT "GOOD ENOUGH" LOOKS LIKE

TESTED WITH

TESTED ON

DECISION RULE #2

RECURRING APPROVAL what keeps landing on your desk?

TRIGGER when does this rule apply?

THRESHOLD OR CRITERIA the number that decides it

WHO DECIDES WITHOUT YOU

REVIEW DATE when it gets checked

WHAT "GOOD ENOUGH" LOOKS LIKE

TESTED WITH

TESTED ON

DECISION RULE #3

RECURRING APPROVAL what keeps landing on your desk?

TRIGGER when does this rule apply?

THRESHOLD OR CRITERIA the number that decides it

WHO DECIDES WITHOUT YOU

REVIEW DATE when it gets checked

WHAT "GOOD ENOUGH" LOOKS LIKE

TESTED WITH

TESTED ON

DECISION RULE #4

RECURRING APPROVAL what keeps landing on your desk?

TRIGGER when does this rule apply?

THRESHOLD OR CRITERIA the number that decides it

WHO DECIDES WITHOUT YOU

REVIEW DATE when it gets checked

WHAT "GOOD ENOUGH" LOOKS LIKE

TESTED WITH

TESTED ON

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

When a rule is working

A decision rule is working when the outcome stops being reported to you as a decision, only as a summary. If people still check with you after the rule exists, it's either too vague, or nobody told them it exists.

- [ ] The rule has a number or a clear condition in it.
- [ ] It names one owner, not a team.
- [ ] The people it affects have seen it and know where it lives.
- [ ] It has a review date in the calendar.

NOTES

> This is the same discipline behind any reliable operation: whether someone new could run your core process from written instructions alone. A decision rule applies it to judgement calls instead of tasks.

Want to install this properly?

Install decision rules across every part of the business, not just the approvals you happened to notice.

Book a discovery call

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